viral advising people to use the explanation 'I believed my Prime Minister and my Finance Minister when they said I could deposit notes till Dec 30'. Realizing the ridiculousness of what they had done, the RBI reversed the notification the next day, albeit only for customers with 'KYC compliant accounts'.

On 30 December, President Pranab Mukherjee signed the Specified Bank Notes Cessation of Liabilities Ordinance, 2016. The ordinance stated that the SBNs (old ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes) would cease to be liabilities of the RBI from 31 December 2016. Further, these notes would no longer be guaranteed by the Central Government. Also, that holding the notes would be an offence and punishable with a minimum fine of ₹10,000, or five times the value of notes possessed, whichever was higher.

The same day, a notification was issued by the Department of Economic Affairs permitting a grace period for depositing the demonetized notes only for Indian citizens who had gone abroad (for three months till 31 March 2017) and for Non-Resident Indians or NRIs (for six months till 30 June 2017).

The RBI website explained the combined net effect of the ordinance and the notification.

The only people who could exchange old notes at the RBI's counters after 30 December 2016 were Indians who were abroad between 9 November and 30 December and NRIs.

NRIs could only deposit ₹25,000 as per FEMA law restrictions, and they would have to physically show the old ₹500 and ₹1,000 rupee notes to customs officials at the airport and get a declaration form stamped before they could deposit the demonetized currency in RBI during the grace period. The RBI designated five offices – Mumbai, New Delhi, Chennai, Kolkata and Nagpur – to exchange the old notes.

This was totally inexplicable and yet another U-turn on the promise that the Prime Minister had made in his address to the nation